

NUDGE

1. Passage anchor

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a **nudge** in the right direction”, and that made all the difference.”

Passage meaning

nudge = a small, gentle push or encouragement that influences someone without forcing them
輕推；輕輕提醒；溫和促使；小小的推動

Here, **a nudge in the right direction** is figurative.

It means:

= a small amount of guidance or encouragement that helps someone move toward a better choice, attitude, or path

朝正確方向的一點推動；溫和的引導；小小的鼓勵

Practice

1. Her advice gave me the **nudge** I needed to apply for the course.

她的建議給了我所需要的那一點**推動**，讓我去申請那門課。

2. Sometimes people do not need a complete solution; they just need a **nudge** in the right direction.

有時候人們不需要完整答案，只需要一點**朝正確方向的引導**。

Core meanings of NUDGE

2. nudge — gently push someone or something

= push someone or something lightly, usually with your elbow, hand, or body

輕推；輕碰

Examples

1. She **nudged** me with her elbow.

她用手肘**輕輕碰了我一下**。

2. He **nudged** the door open with his foot.

他用腳**輕輕把門推開**。

This is the central literal verb meaning.

3. nudge someone

= give someone a small physical push, often to get their attention

輕推某人；碰某人一下

Examples

1. Tom **nudged me** and pointed at the clock.
Tom **輕推了我一下**，然後指向時鐘。
2. She **nudged her friend** when the teacher entered.
老師進來時，她**輕碰朋友一下**提醒對方。

4. nudge something

= move something slightly by pushing it gently

輕推某物；把.....稍微移動

Examples

1. He **nudged the chair** closer to the table.
他把椅子**輕輕推近桌子**。
2. She **nudged the cup aside**.
她把杯子**輕輕推到一旁**。

Physical movement by a small amount

5. nudge something up / down / forward

= move something by a small amount

把.....稍微調高 / 調低 / 往前移

Examples

1. Can you **nudge the volume up** a little?
你可以把音量**稍微調高一點**嗎？
2. He **nudged the chair forward**.

他把椅子**稍微往前推**。

This can be literal or extended.

Gentle encouragement

6. nudge someone to do something

= gently encourage or prompt someone to take an action

輕輕促使某人做某事；提醒某人去做某事

Examples

1. Her teacher **nudged her to speak more confidently**.

老師**溫和地鼓勵她更有自信地說話**。

2. A reminder **nudged me to finish the form**.

一個提醒**促使我把表格填完**。

This is one of the most important figurative senses.

7. nudge someone toward something

= gently influence someone toward a choice, attitude, or outcome

引導某人朝.....發展；把某人輕推向.....

Examples

1. His mentor **nudged him toward a career in teaching**.

他的導師**引導他走向教職**。

2. The experience **nudged her toward a different way of thinking**.

那段經歷**讓她逐漸轉向不同的思考方式**。

Very close to the passage.

Influence without force

8. nudge — influence behavior subtly

= cause or encourage a change in behavior through a small, indirect influence rather than force
輕推；誘導；以溫和方式影響

Examples

1. The new layout **nudges customers toward healthier choices**.

新的陳列方式**溫和地引導顧客選擇更健康的產品**。

2. The app sends reminders to **nudge users to exercise**.

這個應用程式會發送提醒，**促使用戶去運動**。

This sense is especially common in behavioral economics, public policy, design, and technology.

Noun: small physical push

9. a nudge — a small gentle push

= a light physical push

輕推；輕碰

Examples

1. She gave me a **nudge** with her elbow.

她用手肘**輕推了我一下**。

2. One small **nudge** moved the box forward.

輕輕一**推**，箱子就往前移了。

Noun: small encouragement or prompt

10. a nudge — gentle encouragement

= a small action, reminder, or piece of encouragement that prompts someone to act

輕輕的推動；提醒；鼓勵

Examples

1. I needed a little **nudge** to get started.

我只是需要一點**推動**才開始行動。

2. Her message gave me the **nudge** I needed.

她的訊息給了我所需要的那點**鼓勵 / 推力**。

11. give someone a nudge

= gently push or encourage someone

輕推某人一下；給某人一點提醒 / 鼓勵

Examples

1. He gave me a **nudge** to get my attention.
他**輕碰了我一下**來引起我的注意。
2. My friend gave me the **nudge** I needed to apply.
我的朋友給了我需要的那一點**鼓勵**，讓我去申請。

Context decides whether it is physical or figurative.

12. a nudge in the right direction

= a small amount of help or guidance that moves someone toward a better solution or course

朝正確方向的一點推動；小小的正確引導

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. The teacher did not give me the answer, just a **nudge in the right direction**.
老師沒有直接告訴我答案，只是給了我一點**正確方向的提示**。
2. Her encouragement was the **nudge in the right direction** that I needed.
她的鼓勵正是我需要的那一點**正向推動**。

Behavioral economics / policy

13. nudge — behavioral intervention

= a small change in how choices are presented that influences behavior without removing freedom of choice

行為誘導；輕推策略

Examples

1. Putting healthier food at eye level is a classic **nudge**.
把健康食物放在視線高度是一種典型的**輕推策略**。

2. The policy uses **nudges** rather than bans.
這項政策使用**行為誘導**，而不是禁止手段。

This is a distinct established technical sense.

14. nudge theory

= approach in behavioral science that uses small changes in choice environments to influence decisions

輕推理論；**助推理論**

Examples

1. **Nudge theory** is often discussed in behavioral economics.
輕推理論常見於行為經濟學討論中。

2. The campaign applies principles from **nudge theory**.
這個宣傳活動運用了**輕推理論**的原則。

Small quantitative change

15. nudge a number / rate / price higher or lower

= cause a number or level to move slightly

使.....小幅上升 / 下降

Examples

1. Higher demand **nudged** prices upward.
較高的需求讓價格**小幅上升**。

2. The announcement **nudged** the share price higher.
這項公告讓股價**略微上漲**。

Common in business and news writing.

Reminders / digital prompts

16. nudge — reminder or prompt

= a small reminder designed to prompt action

****提醒；提示****

Examples

1. The app sends a ****nudge**** if you forget to log your progress.

如果你忘了記錄進度，應用程式會發出一個****提醒****。

2. I sent him a gentle ****nudge**** about the deadline.

我針對截止日期給了他一個溫和的****提醒****。

Related forms

17. nudging

= the act of gently pushing, prompting, or influencing

****輕推；引導；誘導****

Examples

1. ****Nudging**** can sometimes change behavior without strict rules.

****輕推式引導****有時能在沒有嚴格規定的情況下改變行為。

2. The system works by ****nudging users toward better habits****.

這套系統透過****引導使用者建立更好習慣****來運作。

18. nudged

Past tense / past participle of ****nudge****.

Examples

1. She ****nudged me**** toward the door.

她****輕推我****往門口走。

2. The experience ****nudged me toward a different career path****.

那段經歷****促使我逐漸走向不同的職涯方向****。

High-value expressions

19. a gentle nudge

= a mild reminder, push, or encouragement

****溫和的提醒；輕輕的推動****

Examples

1. Sometimes a ****gentle nudge**** is enough.
有時候一個****溫和的提醒****就夠了。
2. She gave the team a ****gentle nudge**** to finish on time.
她稍微****提醒並催促團隊****準時完成。

20. need a nudge

= need a little encouragement or prompting

****需要一點鼓勵 / 提醒****

Examples

1. I knew what to do; I just needed a ****nudge****.
我知道該怎麼做，只是需要一點****推動****。
2. Some students need a small ****nudge**** before they speak up.
有些學生在開口之前需要一點****鼓勵****。

Key contrasts

21. nudge vs push

****push****

= apply physical force or strongly encourage someone

****推；推動****

****nudge****

= push very lightly or influence gently

****輕推；輕輕促使****

Compare:

> He ****pushed the door open****.

> 他把門推開。

> He ****nudged the door open****.

> 他輕輕把門推開。

Figuratively:

> They ****pushed him to accept the offer****.

> 他們強力催促他接受提議。

> They ****nudged him toward accepting the offer****.

> 他們溫和地引導他考慮接受提議。

****Nudge**** is softer and less forceful.

22. nudge vs encourage

****encourage****

= give someone confidence, support, or motivation

****鼓勵****

****nudge****

= provide a small prompt that moves someone toward action

****推一把；促使****

Compare:

> She ****encouraged me**** to speak.

> 她鼓勵我發言。

> She gave me a little ****nudge**** to speak up.

> 她稍微推了我一把，讓我開口。

A nudge is often smaller, subtler, and more indirect.

23. nudge vs prompt

****prompt****

= cause someone to act, speak, or remember something

****促使；提示****

****nudge****

= prompt gently and subtly

****輕推；溫和促使****

Compare:

> The question ****prompted me to think again****.

> 那個問題促使我重新思考。

> Her comment ****nudged me toward a different conclusion****.

> 她的話讓我慢慢轉向另一個結論。

24. nudge vs remind

****remind****

= make someone remember something

****提醒****

****nudge****

= may remind someone, but with the purpose of moving them toward action

****提醒並促使行動****

Compare:

> Please ****remind me**** about the meeting.

> 請提醒我開會。

> Give me a ****nudge**** if I haven't replied by Friday.

> 如果我星期五前還沒回覆，就****提醒 / 催我一下****。

25. nudge vs pressure

****pressure****

= strongly influence someone, often making them feel they have little choice

****施壓****

****nudge****

= influence gently while leaving choice intact

****溫和引導****

Compare:

> They **pressured him** to agree.

> 他們對他施壓，要他同意。

> They **nudged him** toward agreement.

> 他們溫和地引導他朝同意的方向走。

This distinction is central to the modern behavioral sense.

Meaning map

The central concept of **nudge** is:

a small push

From this develop:

Physical

nudge someone with your elbow

→ **輕推；輕碰**

Small movement

nudge something forward

→ **稍微移動**

Encouragement

nudge someone to act

→ **輕輕促使**

Guidance

nudge someone in the right direction

→ **溫和引導**

Behavior design

a behavioral nudge

→ **以小幅改變影響選擇**

Quantity

nudge prices higher
→ ****使數值小幅變動****

Reminder

send someone a nudge
→ ****提醒 / 催一下****

The passage uses the figurative guidance sense:

****a small physical push****
→ ****a small psychological or emotional push toward a better path****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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nudge — physical verb	用很小的力氣輕推、輕碰某人或某物
nudge someone	輕推某人一下，常用來引起注意或示意
nudge something	用輕微力量把某物稍微移動
nudge something up/down/forward	把某物或數值稍微調高、調低或移動
nudge someone to do something	用溫和、非強迫的方式促使某人採取行動
nudge someone toward something	逐漸引導某人朝某個選擇、方向或結果前進
nudge — subtle influence	不強迫，而是透過小幅改變或提示影響行為
a nudge — physical	一次很輕的推或碰
a nudge — encouragement	一點提醒、鼓勵或推動，促使某人採取行動
give someone a nudge	輕推某人一下；比喻給某人一點提醒或鼓勵
a nudge in the right direction	給某人一點幫助或引導，使其朝較好的方向前進
behavioral nudge	透過選擇環境的小改變，在不強迫的情況下影響行為
nudge theory	利用小幅選擇設計來影響決策的輕推 / 助推理論
nudge prices/rates higher/lower	使價格、比率等小幅上升或下降
nudge — reminder	用來提醒並促使某人採取行動的小提示
a gentle nudge	溫和而不具強迫性的提醒、鼓勵或推動

Passage recap

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a ****nudge in the right direction****...”

Here:

****nudge**** = ****a small but helpful amount of encouragement or guidance****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **輕輕推了一把**

* **給了一點引導**

* **給了一點鼓勵**

* **朝正確方向推了一把**

Natural contextual translation:

陳老師只是輕輕推了我一把，讓我朝正確的方向前進。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

a nudge in the right direction

= **a small amount of guidance or encouragement that helps someone move toward a better choice or course**

朝正確方向的一點推動；溫和的引導；小小的鼓勵

The metaphor is:

physical nudge

→ 輕輕推一下

becomes

figurative nudge

→ 不替你做決定，只是給你一點力量或提示，讓你自己往前走。

That nuance fits the passage especially well: Mrs. Chan did not control the speaker's path; she simply gave the speaker enough encouragement to begin moving in a better direction.